



Rajeev Singh,
Country Head, BenQ

Rajeev Singh, Country Head of BenQ, another sponsor, said, "We do need more events like the Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup because in India. The gaming industry is still in its nascent stages. Especially competitive gaming, is yet to pick up because of a lack of good tournaments. We are happy to be associated with the Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup because it is a great opportunity for gamers."

Mr. Rounak Sen, Captain of the winning team Neck Break, said, "Winning felt good, as it had a good prize pool. It felt great to be a part of TE Gaming Cup. The entire set up of the event was very grooving. We are looking



TEGC 2015 Champions - Team Neck Break with the champions trophy

forward for TE Gaming Cup 2016".

Mr. Bari Anwar Nasir, Captain, Team Elunes, 1st Runner Up, said, "The event was one of the best gaming event in India. Our team participated last year too but this year the amount of brand pool was very nice. Such events help the gaming enthusiastic to sharpen their skills and showcase their gaming talents. Looking forward for TE Gaming Cup 2016".

Mr. Rohan Gokhale, Captain, Team Bad Xcuse, 2nd Runner Up, told, "The event was very well organized and we look forward for more such events in India. Besides the cash prize there were also other prizes which were really very good".

Standing firm as the 19th largest economy in the world, with a well-developed capitalist economy, Taiwan has proven itself to be a major player in the market. Taiwan not only has developed into a hub for tech, but is also more familiar than Japan and Korea with classic martial arts themes and the aesthetics favoured by the 100 million online gamers in China. With events like the Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup, Taiwan is looking at finding a firm footing in the Indian gaming market.

Gaming in India in the days of yore:

The gaming industry in India has come a long way from the era of Super Mario Bros to such high-end gaming extravaganzas. According to a FICCI-KPMG report, the Indian gaming industry, which was worth \$171.66 million in 2010 is expected to grow at a compounded annual growth rate (CAGR) of 32.1% through 2015. But to understand its journey to this stage of development, the history of gaming in India needs to be looked at closer.

India was first introduced to gaming by Samurai India when it brought in the licensed Nintendo Entertainment System clones. Although not very affordable, they did become a hit and their loyal base of customers referred to them as the 'TV Game'. The middle class found its gadget in the form of relatively, widely produced and unlicensed '100000 games in 1' cartridges and the green chips with black spots in the middle were a common sight around the television.

Gaming by the numbers:

In 2013, the Indian gaming industry was worth US \$250 million, which at the time did not account for even 1% of the annual global market. But if someone had decided to dismiss the fate of the industry based on numbers alone, they would have been mistaken as the industry has been growing rapidly.

According to Arnold Su, the National Sales Manager for the Consumer PC business at ASUS India Pvt Ltd, "The gaming industry in India today is pegged at \$890 million in size as per NASSCOM, with at least two companies coming up every month

and growing at around 30 percent every year. India, being a cash savvy society, is still not very comfortable with the idea of paying for gaming. Despite that, the industry has grown exponentially over the last few years and will continue to do so"

The last 15 years has seen a seminal change in the economic pace of in India. The country now has a robust demographic structure that in turn is offering immense potential for the gaming industry. A blend of rising urban incomes, education, development of the IT sector and telecom



Arnold Su,
National Sales Manager,
ASUS India Pvt Ltd

growth have offered the perfect platform for the gaming industry. As Sunil Grewal, a Director at Gigabyte Technology (India) Pvt. Ltd mentions, "The popularity of gaming is fuelled mainly by the consumers' growing attraction for leisure gaming activities and also the rise in disposable incomes. The growth of Internet connectivity has already added to popularity of gaming, because this gives the gaming enthusiast a platform to know and see what's happening in other parts of the world."

The 'Game' of games:

While casual gaming is prevalent in most parts of the country, it is competitive gaming that is still in its nascent stages. Mr. Singh blames the lack of a well developed ecosystem in India for this. "The ecosystem for gaming is not that well developed in India. Most people take up gaming as a hobby and it is tough to take it up as a profession because there are not many gaming tournaments. There is no big prize money on a regular basis. Most of the gamers do it because they are passionate about it. Competitive gaming is in its very early stages here. But it will develop."

Tournaments like the Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup are competitions that may be responsible for further developing the market, especially because of the big bucks and extensive opportunities they offer. The Cup came back for its second edition in August this year. After the overwhelming success of the contest last year, this time Delhi too was added to the venue along with Mumbai. From a cash prize of Rs 2 lakh last year, this year a whopping Rs 4 lakh was up for grabs.

Mr. Grewal is optimistic about such tournaments, "A few years back, gaming was just a private affair. But nowadays, you see gaming events being streamed live online, with a highly loyal audience who waits impatiently for the event. It's slowly but steadily becoming a competitive spectator sport."

In fact, according to the Internet Advertising Bureau, women make up 52% of gamers, and while many may think that gaming is something kids or teenagers do, the truth is that over half the gaming population is 30 or above. E-commerce is perhaps playing a role here. Says Mr. Su, "E-commerce has given the gaming industry a huge boost. In fact, e-commerce has helped take hardcore game distribution to more than 220 cities. This, in turn, is helping the brick-and-mortar format of game retailers to flourish, since they now have a ready base of customers who are exposed to gaming."